RAJASTHANI COLLECTION

NO. 01



RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Dal Baati Churma

Baked Wheat Balls, Spiced Lentils
and Sweet Crumbled Wheat

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Dal Baati Churma

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Dal Baati Churma

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Food Built to Survive the Desert

Dal baati churma is Rajasthan's answer to one of the harshest culinary challenges any regional cuisine has faced: how do you feed people well in a desert climate with limited water, scarce fresh produce, and long distances between settlements? The answer, refined over centuries, is a three-part meal engineered for durability as much as flavor — baati, hard wheat dough balls traditionally baked over hot coals or buried in desert sand heated by fire, could keep for days without spoiling, making them ideal food for traveling merchants, soldiers, and desert caravans.

The dal that accompanies baati is typically panchmel, a hearty five-lentil blend (featured elsewhere in this collection) that provides protein and substance, while churma — the same wheat dough used for baati, but crumbled and sweetened with ghee and jaggery or sugar — supplies the meal's dessert course and its concentrated calories, essential for anyone facing a long day of desert travel or physical labor.

Today dal baati churma has moved well beyond its practical origins to become Rajasthan's most celebrated culinary export, a centerpiece of weddings, festivals, and any occasion calling for a proper feast — though the traditional method of baking baati over coals or in hot sand persists at dedicated restaurants and rural households, prized for a smoky depth that no oven fully replicates.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Food Built to Survive the Desert, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Historically engineered as durable, long-keeping food for Rajasthan's desert climate, valued by traveling merchants and desert communities. Traditionally baati were baked over hot coals or buried in sand heated by fire, a method still practiced in some rural areas and specialty restaurants. Now Rajasthan's most celebrated culinary export, a centerpiece of weddings, festivals, and special family gatherings. The three-part structure — savory baati, protein-rich dal, sweet churma — reflects a complete, self-sufficient meal designed for a demanding climate.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

30m	45m	6	Med
ACTIVE PREP	BAKE TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowls
- Oven, or traditional coal/sand setup
- Wire rack
- Food processor or mortar and pestle, for crumbling churma
- A separate panchmel dal recipe (see this collection) to serve alongside

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Baati keep remarkably well at room temperature for several days, wrapped in a cloth, reflecting their traditional role as durable travel food. Churma keeps refrigerated for up to a week in an airtight container. Dal is best made fresh but keeps refrigerated for 3–4 days.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the baati

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta), coarse if available	2 cups	250 g	2 katori
Semolina (sooji) — optional, for texture	2 tbsp	20 g	2 tbsp
Ghee, melted (for the dough)	¼ cup	60 g	¼ katori
Baking soda	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Water, as needed	¾ cup approx.	180 ml approx.	¾ katori approx.
Ghee, melted, for dipping	½ cup	120 g	½ katori

For the churma

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Reserved baati dough or extra wheat flour, cooked and crumbled	1 cup	150 g	1 katori
Ghee	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Jaggery or sugar, grated	⅓ cup	60 g	⅓ katori
Cardamom powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Chopped almonds or cashews, for garnish	2 tbsp	20 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Coarse whole wheat flour, sometimes labeled "chakki atta," gives the most authentic baati texture; regular whole wheat flour works as a substitute, though the result may be slightly less textured. Traditional baati baking uses coal or sand heat, which most home cooks won't have access to — this recipe includes a reliable oven method that still delivers excellent results, detailed in the instructions.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Baati Dough

01 MIX THE DOUGH

Combine the whole wheat flour, semolina if using, baking soda, and salt. Rub in the melted ghee until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs, then gradually add water, kneading to a firm, slightly stiff dough — firmer than a typical roti dough.

02 REST THE DOUGH

Cover and rest for 15–20 minutes. Set aside about a quarter of the dough separately if you plan to make churma from the same batch.

> **Chef tip.** baati dough should be noticeably firmer and drier than naan or roti dough — this firmness is what allows it to hold its shape and develop a hard, cracked crust when baked.

03 SHAPE INTO BALLS

Divide the main portion of dough into 8 balls, shaping them firmly and smoothly, pressing a slight indentation in the center of each with your thumb.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Baati Dough, continued



COOKING CHECKPOINT

The dough should feel firm and hold its shape when rolled into a ball, not soft or sticky like most other Indian bread doughs.

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Baking & Assembling

04 BAKE THE BAATI

Preheat oven to 375°F / 190°C. Place the dough balls on a wire rack and bake for 35–40 minutes, turning occasionally, until deeply golden and firm with visible cracks on the surface.



Texture indicator. a properly baked baati should sound hollow when tapped and feel hard and firm all the way through, not soft in the center.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Baking & Assembling, continued

05 MAKE THE CHURMA

If using reserved dough, shape it into a few small balls and bake or boil until firm, similar to baati but smaller. Once cooked, crumble into small pieces using a food processor or by hand.

06 SWEETEN THE CHURMA

Heat ghee in a pan and add the crumbled wheat, stirring for 2–3 minutes until lightly toasted. Remove from heat and mix in the jaggery and cardamom powder while still warm, so the jaggery melts and coats evenly. Garnish with chopped nuts.

07 ASSEMBLE AND DIP

Crack each hot baati slightly and dip generously into melted ghee, letting it soak in fully — this step is essential to the dish's rich, traditional flavor. Serve alongside dal and churma.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Skipping the generous ghee dip is a common shortcut that leaves baati dry and dense rather than rich and flavorful. Don't be shy with the ghee — it's central to the dish's identity.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Baati crushed or broken and topped with dal, eaten alongside a portion of sweet churma.
- A centerpiece dish at Rajasthani weddings and festivals, served with great ceremony.

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How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served as a thali with whole baati, a bowl of dal, and a small portion of churma arranged separately.

Family Style

- A generous shared meal, with baati baked in batches and dal kept warm at the center of the table.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Baati Right

- A firm, dry dough is essential — a soft dough won't develop the characteristic hard, cracked crust when baked.
- The final ghee dip should be generous and thorough — this is not a dish to go light on ghee.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Baati keep exceptionally well and can be baked several days ahead, reheated briefly before serving.
- Churma keeps well refrigerated, making it practical to prepare in advance of a larger gathering.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Dedicated dal baati restaurants often finish baati with a second brief roast directly over open coals after oven baking, adding a smoky dimension that a home oven alone can't achieve — worth trying if you have access to a grill or fire pit.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

420 kcal	9 g	48 g	22 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Tree nuts. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Traditional Coal-Baked Baati	the most authentic version, baked directly over hot coals or in heated sand.
Stuffed Baati	some households fill the dough with a spiced besan or dal mixture before baking.
Mawa Churma	a richer churma variation using khoya (reduced milk solids) alongside the sweetened wheat.

Can I make baati without an oven?

Yes — traditional methods use hot coals or heated sand; a grill with indirect heat can also work as a home alternative, though the oven method in this recipe is the most reliable and accessible.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why is my baati soft instead of hard and cracked?

Usually a dough that was too soft or wet, or insufficient baking time. Keep the dough firm and bake until genuinely golden and hollow-sounding.

Can I make churma with store-bought ingredients?

Yes — some cooks use store-bought whole wheat rusks or biscuits, crumbled and sweetened the same way, as a shortcut version.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Baati	hard, baked wheat dough balls, traditionally cooked over coals or in hot sand.
Churma	sweetened, crumbled wheat dough, the dessert component of this dish.
Panchmel Dal	a hearty five-lentil dal, the traditional accompaniment to baati.
Chakki Atta	coarsely ground whole wheat flour, ideal for baati's traditional texture.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Dal Baati Churma

30m	45m
ACTIVE PREP	BAKE TIME
6	Med
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

BAATI

Whole wheat flour	250 g
Semolina	20 g
Ghee	60 g
Baking soda	1 g
Salt	4.5 g
Water	180 ml approx.
Ghee	120 g

CHURMA

Reserved baati dough or extra wheat flour	150 g
Ghee	45 g
Jaggery or sugar	60 g
Cardamom powder	1 g
Chopped almonds or cashews	20 g

METHOD

01 **Mix the dough.** Combine the whole wheat flour, semolina if using, baking soda, and salt.

02 **Rest the dough.** Cover and rest for 15–20 minutes.

03 **Shape into balls.** Divide the main portion of dough into 8 balls, shaping them firmly and smoothly, pressing a slight indentation in the center of each with your thumb.

04 **Bake the baati.** Preheat oven to 375°F / 190°C.

05 **Make the churma.** If using reserved dough, shape it into a few small balls and bake or boil until firm, similar to baati but smaller.

06 **Sweeten the churma.** Heat ghee in a pan and add the crumbled wheat, stirring for 2–3 minutes until lightly toasted.

07 **Assemble and dip.** Crack each hot baati slightly and dip generously into melted ghee, letting it soak in fully — this step is essential to the dish's rich, traditional flavor.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

- [ ] Whole wheat flour — 250 g
- [ ] Ghee — see recipe
- [ ] Salt — 4.5 g
- [ ] Jaggery or sugar — 60 g
- [ ] Chopped almonds or cashews — 20 g
- [ ] Semolina — 20 g
- [ ] Baking soda — 1 g
- [ ] Reserved baati dough or extra wheat flour — 150 g
- [ ] Cardamom powder — 1 g

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